

# THE HUMAN TOUCH

After the pandemic struck, the tech giant reached out to its employees to understand the challenges they were facing and took steps to put them at ease

By **Nidhi Singal**

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► **THE CHARMS OF** a job at Google are many—über-cool offices, an array of gadgets, unlimited food and employee benefits, to name a few. Little wonder then that Google India has been among the top few companies in the *BT-Tagd* Best Companies to Work For in India rankings. A great workplace, however, is more than just perks, especially during unprecedented times such as the Covid-19 pandemic. After the onset of the pandemic, Google reached out to its employees—called Googlers—to understand the challenges they were facing.

“The pandemic has served as a reminder that we have a deep responsibility to care for our employees and their families, and it’s important to lean into our values as we think about ways we can best support them during this trying time. This led us to relook at our policies and benefits to ensure we are providing the right level of care. Having a direct line to employees is invaluable and we wanted to make sure we understand how our Googlers are feeling during this time,” says Anny Tampling, Market HR Director for APAC, Google.

Google used multiple data sources—including surveys, interviews and experimental pilots—to get the whole picture about how Googlers feel. Listening to the community has helped its teams and leaders identify where to focus their efforts in caring for Googlers as it returns to offices and transitions to a hybrid working model. For instance, Google saw that caregivers needed extra support, so it implemented a Covid-19-specific carer’s leave extension policy. And when Googlers were feeling burnt out, it introduced global day-offs so that they could take a break and recharge themselves.



**FOCUSSED ON EMPLOYEES** Anny Tampling, Market HR Director for APAC, Google

“We’ve learnt from Googlers that they appreciate the added flexibility especially in a time of Covid-19... so providing the flexibility like carers’ leave, flexible working arrangements and work-from-anywhere weeks make a difference to how our employees feel supported and, overall, about working at Google,” says Tampling.

Once the company realised that remote work had become a way of life, it focussed on ensuring that Googlers continued to learn, grow and develop their skills in this

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**GOOGLE INDIA**

**Top attributes**

- Clarity of company goals
- Growth and learning opportunities
- Flexibility at work